



Tips & Tricks

Installing true type fonts in Ubuntu

Step 1. Copy the fonts to `/usr/share/fonts` or `/home/.fonts`
Step 2. Run the following command from the terminal

```
sudo fc-cache -fv
```

The fonts have been installed now.

The same steps can be followed in Fedora, Debian and many other Linux distributions.

—sarin, sarincv@gmail.com

Send mails quickly

Sometimes it becomes very essential for an administrator to use command line tools to send mails. Here is a tip for such IT-admins and advanced users – a short mutt (a powerful text-based mail client) config file that will configure a command line mail client.

For this I would consider the popular Gmail service and this file will be similar for many other mail services.

Create a new file in the home directory named `“.muttrc”` (hidden file) and put the following directives in it.

```
set realname="Your FullName"
set from="user@gmail.com"
set spoolfile="imap://imap.gmail.com:993/INBOX"
set folder="imap://imap.gmail.com:993"
set postponed="imap://imap.gmail.com:993/[Gmail]/Drafts"
set smtp_url="smtp://user[:pass]@smtp.gmail.com"
set imap_user="user"
set imap_pass="pass"
```

Giving a password in the file is optional. Just give the command `mutt` and that's it!

—Medhamsh, myself@medhamsh.org

Formatting a pen drive using Terminal

First, run the following command:

```
$dmesg | tail
```

You will get the following output that will confirm the device name for your pen drive:

```
[ 9921.681164] sda: Write Protect is off
[ 9921.681174] sda: Mode Sense: 23 00 00 00
[ 9921.681170] sda: assuming drive cache: write through
[ 9921.709138] SCSI device sda: 4030464 512-byte hdwr sectors
(2064 MB)
[ 9921.728951] sda: Write Protect is off
[ 9921.728963] sda: Mode Sense: 23 00 00 00
[ 9921.728967] sda: assuming drive cache: write through
[ 9921.721225] sda:
[ 9921.727896] sd 0:0:0:0: Attached scsi removable disk sda
[ 9921.744187] sd 0:0:0:0: Attached scsi generic sg0 type 0
```

Then unmount your pen drive by using the code below:

```
sudo umount /dev/sda
```

Use the `mkfs.vfat` command to format to the FAT32 filesystem, or `mkfs.ext3` to format to the ext3 filesystem.

```
$sudo mkfs.vfat -n "Label" -I /dev/sda
```

Replace `Label` with the name you want the pen drive to have. When done with formatting, you'll be returned to the prompt.

—Dange Laxmikant M., dange.laxmikant@gmail.com

Root password recovery

If you forget the root password, you can change it by entering the system in single user mode, as shown below.